OPEC Sovereigns and Heads of States was held in Algiers in March 1975. The outbreak of the Iranian Revolution in 1979 also produced another oil crisis, and concerted effort by OPEC had hit the oil market hard.

Following the Iran–Iraq war, the 1980s witnessed another rise in oil prices at the beginning of the decade but soon there was a dramatic decline in prices, which culminated in a collapse in 1986 and set the beginning of the third oil-pricing crisis. Oil prices faced a six-year decline with a 46 per cent price drop in 1986. This also harmed the OPEC unity as the Western nations searched for alternatives to lessen the potential impact of the future price-shock induced by OPEC. This included measures of increasing oil production outside the OPEC like the Central Asian region to tide over the ‘oil politics’ of the OPEC countries.

In the 1990s, the OPEC came to the relief of the world when a major oil crisis was averted due to the sanctions against Iraq to export oil. A sudden and steep rise in prices on panic-stricken markets was offset by output increases from OPEC members. Collective action by OPEC and some leading non-OPEC producers again brought about a recovery when in 1998 there was a collapse, in the wake of the economic downturn in South-East Asia. The global melt down of 2008, as well as the declining prices of oil, has again called for a concerted effort of the OPEC countries to address the crisis.